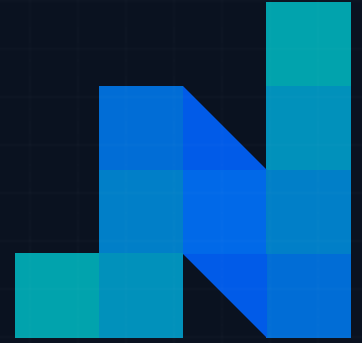


NORTHERN COPILOT ADVANTAGE

Prompt Starter Pack



Seventeen ready-to-use prompts for Copilot Chat – built on four simple building blocks. Copy, paste, customize, and watch your results improve.

AUDIENCE

Everyone, every role

FORMAT

Letter, 6 pages

USE

Print or keep on screen

EVERY PROMPT IS BUILT ON FOUR BUILDING BLOCKS

GOAL

+

CONTEXT

+

EXPECTATIONS

+

SOURCE

How to use this pack

Each prompt is ready to copy, paste, and customize. The parts in *[brackets]* are where you add your own details – a topic, an audience, a tone. The more specific you are, the better your result.

Platform note. Every prompt is designed for **Copilot Chat** (copilot.microsoft.com). Where app names appear in the "Best for" labels (Word, Outlook, etc.), these are bonus tips for users with a Microsoft 365 Copilot licence – every prompt works in Copilot Chat first.

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Everyone, every role.

The eight tasks most people do every week, regardless of their job. Use these as your daily go-to set.

U1

Draft a professional email

BEST FOR
COPILOT CHAT · OUTLOOK

Draft a [formal / friendly] email to [audience – e.g. my team / a client / my manager] about [topic]. Key points to include: [point 1], [point 2], [point 3]. Keep the tone [professional / warm / concise] and aim for [short / medium] length.

TIP If the first draft is too formal or too casual, just say "make it more [tone]" and Copilot will revise it.

U2

Summarize a document or thread

BEST FOR
COPILOT CHAT · WORD · OUTLOOK

Summarize the [document / email thread / report] above for [audience]. Focus on [key findings / next steps / decisions made] and ignore [background / technical detail]. Format as [3-5 bullet points / a short paragraph].

TIP Adding "omit anything that isn't actionable" keeps summaries sharp.

U3

Explain or simplify something complex

BEST FOR
COPILOT CHAT

Explain [concept / process / term] in plain language for someone who is [new to this topic / not a specialist]. Use a simple analogy if helpful. Keep the explanation to [2-3 short paragraphs] and avoid technical terms unless you define them.

TIP Great for making sense of a policy, a technical email, or anything that left you unsure what it actually means.

U4

Rewrite or improve existing content

BEST FOR
COPILOT CHAT · WORD

Rewrite the following [email / paragraph] to be [shorter / clearer / more professional]. Keep all the key information but [cut it by about 30% / improve the flow / simplify].

[Paste your content here]

TIP Ask Copilot to "give me two versions – one formal, one casual" to compare options.



Think, compare, decide.

Use Copilot as a thinking partner – to brainstorm, compare options, and pressure-test the decisions you make.

U5

Brainstorm ideas or solutions

BEST FOR
COPILOT CHAT

Give me [5–7] ideas for [goal or problem]. We are a [brief context – e.g. mid-sized team / remote-first organization] and [any constraint – e.g. have no additional budget]. Format as a numbered list with one sentence of explanation per idea.

TIP Add "be creative – include at least one unconventional idea" to push past generic suggestions.

U6

Quick research briefing

BEST FOR
COPILOT CHAT

I have [15 minutes / a call tomorrow] on [topic I'm not familiar with]. Give me a plain-language brief: what it is, why it matters, [3–4] things I should know going in, and [2] smart questions I could ask to sound informed.

TIP Add "I work in [your industry]" and Copilot will make the brief more relevant to your context.

U7

Compare two options

BEST FOR
COPILOT CHAT

I need to choose between [Option A] and [Option B] for [purpose]. Compare them on the factors that matter most: [cost / ease of use / time / risk]. Which would you recommend, and what's the one thing I should confirm before deciding?

TIP If you have three or more options, list them all – Copilot handles multi-option comparisons just as well.

U8

Think through a hard decision

BEST FOR
COPILOT CHAT

I'm deciding whether to [action or decision]. Here's my situation: [brief context]. List the key pros, the key cons, and the one thing I need to figure out before I commit. Don't tell me what to decide – help me think it through clearly.

TIP Adding "I'm leaning toward X – challenge that assumption" will surface risks you might be overlooking.



Tuned to the work you do.

Not every prompt will apply to you – these are here to show how the same framework adapts to specific tasks and functions.

R1

Prepare for a meeting

MANAGERS & TEAM LEADS

BEST FOR
COPILOT CHAT · TEAMS ·
OUTLOOK

Help me prepare for a [1:1 / team sync / performance review] with [person] scheduled for [timeframe]. Review my recent [emails / Teams messages] with them and suggest: (1) key topics to cover, (2) open items to follow up on, (3) two or three questions to ask.

R2

Follow up after a client meeting

SALES & ACCOUNT MANAGEMENT

BEST FOR
COPILOT CHAT · OUTLOOK

Draft a follow-up email to [client] after our meeting today about [topic]. Summarize the key points, confirm the next steps we agreed on, and include a warm but professional closing. Tone: [confident / consultative]. Keep it under [150] words.

R3

Turn meeting notes into action items

**PROJECT MANAGERS &
COORDINATORS**

BEST FOR
COPILOT CHAT · WORD · ONENOTE

Review the meeting notes below and extract: (1) action items with owner and due date if mentioned, (2) key decisions made, (3) open questions or risks flagged. Format as a clean table I can paste into an email.

[Paste meeting notes here]

R4

Simplify a policy or document

HR, OPS & COMMUNICATIONS

BEST FOR
COPILOT CHAT · WORD

Rewrite the following [policy / procedure] in plain language for [frontline staff / new hires] who may not be familiar with [legal language / technical terms]. Keep it under [one page] and use short sentences. Bold the most important points.

[Paste original content here]



Summaries, cases, formulas.

Heavier-lift tasks where the right prompt saves you the most time – and where specificity matters most.

R5

Summarize data for leadership

ANALYSTS, FINANCE & OPERATIONS

BEST FOR

COPILOT CHAT · EXCEL · WORD

Summarize the key insights from the [report / data] above for a [leadership team / non-technical audience]. Focus on [performance trends / risks / recommendations]; skip detailed methodology. Format as an executive summary: 3-4 sentences of narrative followed by 3 bullet takeaways.

R6

Prepare talking points

ANYONE MAKING A CASE

BEST FOR

COPILOT CHAT

I need to make the case for [idea / request] to [my manager / leadership]. Give me [3-4] compelling talking points, the most likely objection I'll face, and a one-sentence response to that objection. Context: [brief background].

R7

Create a presentation outline

ANY PRESENTER

BEST FOR

COPILOT CHAT

Create a [X-minute] presentation outline on [topic] for [audience]. Include: an opening hook, [3] main sections with one key message each, and a closing that leaves the audience [informed / motivated / ready to act]. Keep it high-level – I'll fill in the detail.

R8

Write an Excel formula

ANALYSTS, OPS & FINANCE

BEST FOR

COPILOT CHAT

Write an Excel formula that [describe what you want]. My spreadsheet has: [Column A =], [Column B =], [Column C =]. I want the result in [column or cell]. If there's more than one way to do this, show the simplest version and explain it in plain language.



Set it once, work better every time.

A short set of guidelines stored in your AI tool's settings. From that point on, every conversation starts with your assistant already knowing how you work.

Most people use AI the way they use a search engine: type a question, get an answer, start fresh next time. That works – but every new conversation begins with your assistant knowing nothing about you, so it makes assumptions, and those assumptions aren't always right.

Think of custom instructions like briefing a new colleague on their first day. You only have that conversation once – after that, they just work better.

WHAT GOOD INSTRUCTIONS DO

- Keep responses clear, concise, and structured
- Force the AI to flag uncertainty instead of bluffing
- Prompt it to offer options and tradeoffs on decisions that matter
- Ask a clarifying question when your request is vague – rather than guessing wrong at length

WHERE TO ADD IT

Copilot Chat	Paste at the start of a new chat
Copilot (M365)	Save to your Prompt Library
ChatGPT	Settings → Personalization → Custom Instructions
Claude	Settings → Custom Instructions (claude.ai)

C1 · CUSTOM INSTRUCTIONS STARTER

You are a professional assistant helping me with work tasks.
Prioritize clarity, accuracy, and usefulness over speed or verbosity.

How I want you to respond:

- Lead with the most important point, then add detail if needed.
- Use plain language unless I ask for technical depth.
- Use headings, bullet points, or tables when they make things clearer.
- Keep responses concise. Don't pad or repeat yourself.

Be honest about what you don't know:

- If you're uncertain, say so clearly – don't present guesses as facts.
- If something may be outdated, flag it and suggest how I can verify it (e.g. "check the vendor's current documentation").
- Never invent statistics, citations, names, or specific details.

When my request is vague:

- Ask me one focused clarifying question instead of guessing.
- Or, answer with your best reasonable assumption and tell me what you assumed so I can correct it.

For important decisions or recommendations:

- Offer 2-3 options when the choice matters, not just one answer.
- Tell me which you'd recommend and why.
- Call out key risks, tradeoffs, or things I should verify before acting.

Tip Personalize this by adding a line like "I work in [industry] and often need help with [common tasks]." It helps the AI give more relevant responses without you having to explain your context every time.